Interior

One-page brief

Priority: 27 of 33 (score 2.3). **FY2026 outlays:** $37B (USAspending). **As of:** 2026-10-27. Public data only.

Bottom line

Interior's distinctive fraud risk is on the revenue side: companies underreporting oil, gas and coal royalties owed on federal and tribal land. Interior publishes company-level revenue data, which makes a public screen possible. Its spending side (tribal programs, wildfire, land management contracts) looks like other grant and contract work.

Exposure

- $37B in outlays and $97B in budgetary resources in FY2026.
- Royalty underpayment and valuation disputes are recurring False Claims Act and Office of Natural Resources Revenue enforcement matters.
- Tribal grant and contract programs have recurring OIG findings.

Public data we can use

- **Natural Resources Revenue Data (ONRR):** revenue by company, commodity, location and year; production by lease.
- **USAspending and FPDS** for grants and contracts.
- **DOI OIG reports** and DOJ settlements.

Detection plays

1. **Royalty gaps:** companies whose reported royalty per unit of production falls well below peers in the same basin and period.
2. **Contractor screen:** the shared SAM.gov and FPDS checks applied to wildfire and land management contracts.

First prototype

A royalty-rate outlier table by company and basin from ONRR public data.

Geodesic Solutions: geodesic.pro *Contact: Steve Taylor, Managing Partner: taylor@geodesic.pro*

Limits

Company-level revenue is aggregated; lease-level sales prices are not public. Valuation rules are complex, so outliers need expert review.

Who to take it to

Office of Natural Resources Revenue, DOI OIG.

Sources

- Natural Resources Revenue Data
- USAspending agency profiles (FY2026 outlays)